Apartment 50: the receipt on the table

Fictional examination staging inspired by Landau's theoretical-minimum tradition and Bulgakov's characters. These are invented lines, not historical quotations.

Behemoth pushed a receipt across the table. Two zeros gleamed on it.

"Perfect," he said. "I have already printed the admission ticket."

Landau covered the zeros with his hand. "Show me the carrier."

Woland covered the signature box. "Show me who checked it."

Behemoth turned the receipt over. The reverse said `unsigned_lab`. Below it were three unchecked conformance laws and an admission verdict: `Refused`.

"The arithmetic may be excellent," said Landau. "Now explain what the result actually permits you to claim."

The examination begins with small distinctions: bytes and meanings, graph edges and declared faces, execution and admission. Then you must reconstruct the four-vertex calculation, defend it with an independent lower bound, and stop a plausible forgery. The final round asks you to design the evidence another person would need to check your work.

Read the student guide, attempt the quiz, and open the instructor key only after an attempt. Hints are allowed; invented evidence is not. A clearly explained missing obligation earns more credit than a confident unsupported success label.

Behemoth may help you find near misses. Keep him away from the release button.

This companion teaches the finite contracts in Paper 004. Its examples grant no operational authorization and assert no physical or model-internal result.